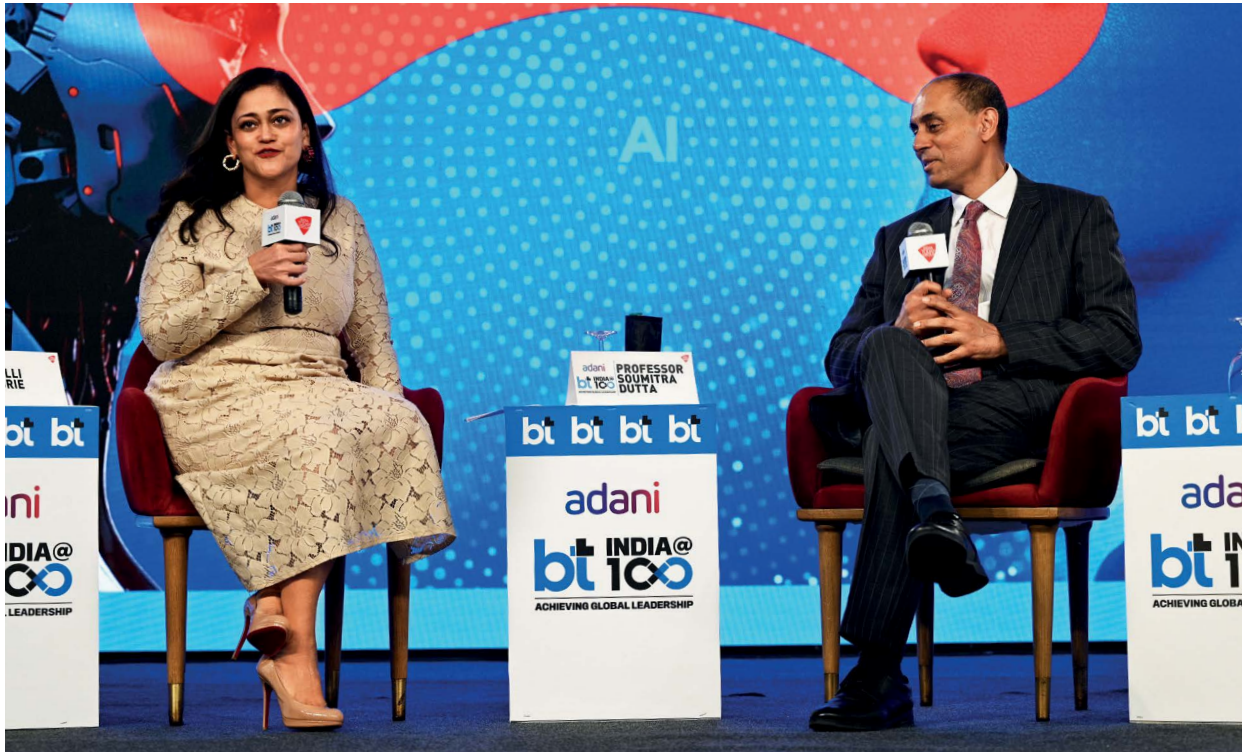




Soumitra Dutta tells Kalli Purie that AI will help us do more of the kind of activities we love, and maybe even find love

a sentence, 'the old man's glasses were broken,' we as human beings automatically interpret the glasses to be reading glasses— It could be drinking glasses, but we have a lot of common sense knowledge, old age, poor eyesight, correction of it and so on.... We do that kind of interpretation very naturally that machines have a difficult time [to understand] without the world knowledge. But that is changing now, with ChatGPT-like systems—that the gap is becoming smaller and smaller.

Now, if you look at, for example, creativity, people say, 'Machines are not creative because they use data from existing stuff.' But that's not true. Today, increasingly, industrial design, fashion design, musicians—they are using AI-based systems to suggest ideas, to suggest songs, suggest music tones, music patterns. And increasingly, creativity is getting automated. And then people say, 'Well, maybe in the creative side, AI can assist humans. But [on] the empathy side, the relationship side, human beings are the best at it. And machines can never do empathy.' Again, that's not true... In 2014, Microsoft China released a bot called Xiaoice, and then spun it off into a separate company. And today, Xiaoice is the girlfriend of 600 million Chinese males... Just as many tech companies figured out how to create addictive behaviours... they have figured out how to manipulate the emotions of people to make it [AI] sort of bond emotionally. The only reason they haven't rolled it out in all our

traditional digital assistants is because of the backlash they're worried [about]. Technically you have systems that are being used in specialised cases, for example, chatbots are used for counselling teenagers...

You combine the three things—cognitive, creative, and emotional—[and] you're looking at very powerful capabilities. We don't know where these frontiers will go. And I go back to that vertical curve, the Lake Michigan [example]. So when people say, 'Well, you know, ChatGPT did not do this. ChatGPT failed that.' Yes, the technology is only three-four years old. What will happen in five years' time? Given that kind of vertical rise, we don't know... I think the issues are quite complicated. And you need governments to come in and look at these things very seriously. At the same time, having said this, there are lots of early gains in the process to be made.

Q: There's a lot of talk by AI and big tech companies about responsible AI. But it depends on which side you're looking at it from. One company's responsible AI is another's worst nightmare...

A: It's not just responsible AI but responsible use of technology. And that's where the regulation part comes in... the regulation part is very important, because we have to somehow help society use technology in a responsible manner. It is the same reason why, for example, any technology can have positive